DESIGN CAPSULE · INDIA 2026–28

# Design Capsule: Handloom quiet luxury

Chanderi, Maheshwari, khadi and tussar in calm colours, with little embellishment and beautiful cloth.

Forecut Editorial · 11 October 2026



# Mood and colour

Ivory
11-0104 TCX
#F3ECDC

Sage
15-6414 TCX
#9FAE8F

Champagne gold
14-0935 TCX
#D8C08A

Dusty rose
15-1611 TCX
#D9A3A6

Pantone TCX (cotton) codes are the nearest match to the screen colour; confirm against a physical Pantone book and lab dips before production.

**Why?** Shoppers want pieces that feel special but can be worn again. Handloom also carries a clear sustainability story, and the government-backed khadi push keeps it visible.

**What?** Craft leads, ornament steps back. Designers showed handloom cotton, Chanderi, handspun khadi and tussar in loose, relaxed shapes with minimal surface work and even raw, unfinished edges.

**Who's showing it?**

- **AK|OK by Anamika Khanna**: Handloom cotton and Chanderi, loose drapes, raw edges
- **Péro by Aneeth Arora**: Handwoven everyday wear
- **Kartik Research**: Handspun khadi with Rabari embroidery

# Key pieces

Forecut flat sketches with reference photos, ready to brief into design.

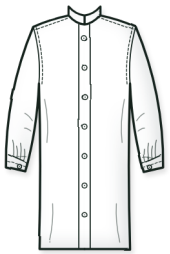


## Pastel handloom sarees

RISING

Dusty rose, powder blue and lavender on handloom bases.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking | Summer 28 Peaking |
| Festive 28 Fading | | | |






## Straight kurta with band collar

PEAKING

Straight kurtas with a Nehru (band) collar and churidar or straight trousers.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Peaking | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking | Summer 28 Peaking |
| Festive 28 Peaking | | | |






## Linen kurta sets

RISING

Breathable linen and cotton-silk for relaxed celebrations.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking | Summer 28 Peaking |
| Festive 28 Fading | | | |



## Tone-on-tone embroidery

RISING

Embroidery in the fabric colour for quiet luxury.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 | Summer 28 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Rising | Peaking | Peaking | Peaking |

| Festive 28 |
|---|
| Fading |



## Chanderi

PEAKING

Light, sheer Madhya Pradesh weave for kurtas, sarees and jackets.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 | Summer 28 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Peaking | Peaking | Peaking | Peaking |

| Festive 28 |
|---|
| Peaking |






## Raw, unfinished edges

EMERGING

Deliberately unfinished edges, as shown by AK|OK.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 | Summer 28 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Emerging | Rising | Rising | Peaking |

| Festive 28 |
|---|
| Peaking |

# Price guide (India)

| KEY GARMENT | VALUE | MID | PREMIUM |
|---|---|---|---|
| Handloom kurta set | ₹1,499–2,999 | ₹3,500–8,000 | ₹15,000+ |
| Chanderi or Maheshwari saree | ₹1,999–3,999 | ₹5,000–12,000 | ₹25,000+ |
| Linen or khadi men's kurta | ₹999–1,999 | ₹2,500–5,000 | ₹9,000+ |

Cost to make: Medium. True handloom has longer lead times and minimums. Use handloom for hero pieces and powerloom Chanderi-look or cotton-silk for value ranges.

## How to build the capsule

- Build a calm-colour handloom capsule: kurta sets, sarees and men's kurtas.
- Swap heavy embroidery for tone-on-tone work at the neckline and cuffs.
- Tell the weave and cluster story on the label and product page.

Sources: Free Press Journal and Harper's Bazaar India, Lakmé Fashion Week 2026; Aza Fashions, ethnic trends 2026.